RakeFlow - Data request letter (Central Railway, WCL, CSTPS)

Data request letter (draft) - adapt header for each recipient

Recipients (send separately):

1. Sr. Divisional Operations Manager (Sr. DOM), Central Railway, Nagpur Division, Nagpur
2. Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (C&W), Central Railway, Nagpur Division (for BPC / examination items)
3. General Manager, Wani Area, Western Coalfields Limited (for Ghugus siding items)
4. Chief Engineer (Coal Handling), Chandrapur Super Thermal Power Station, MAHAGENCO (for unloading items)

From: Team RakeFlow, IE305 Simulation Lab, Industrial Engineering and Operations Research, IIT Bombay, Powai, Mumbai 400076

Date: __ October 2026

Subject: Request for anonymised operational data for an academic simulation study of coal rake cycle time on the Tadali-Ghugus section

Respected Sir / Madam,

We are a team of undergraduate students at IIT Bombay carrying out a semester project under the course IE305 (Simulation Lab), supervised by the IEOR department. The project builds a discrete-event simulation model of the closed-circuit coal rake cycle from the WCL sidings at Ghugus, over the 14 km Tadali-Ghugus single line, to the Chandrapur Super Thermal Power Station siding, and back. The purpose is purely academic: to quantify where a rake spends its cycle time (loading, waiting for the single line, merging onto the main line at Tadali, crew and Brake Power Certificate constraints, unloading) and to evaluate operational options such as path allocation, crew booking and the sanctioned doubling of the section.

We do not require any confidential, commercial or train-specific identifiers. Aggregated, anonymised or historical data are entirely sufficient. We would be grateful for whatever subset of the following you are able to share, in any convenient format (Excel, PDF or even approximate figures given verbally).

A. Section and yard (Operating)

1. Number of running loops and stabling lines at Ghugus and Tadali usable for freight rakes.
2. Sectional speed and block working system on the Tadali-Ghugus section; any permanent speed restrictions.
3. Typical number of loaded and empty coal rakes moved per day on the section (monthly totals for the last 12 months would be ideal).
4. Average detention of loaded rakes at Ghugus awaiting path, and of empties at Tadali awaiting entry to the section.

B. Rake movement (FOIS / COA extract, anonymised) 5. For any 2-4 week period: rake-wise timestamps of placement, loading start/end, release, departure Ghugus, arrival/departure Tadali, arrival CSTPS siding, placement, release empty, departure. Rake IDs may be masked.

C. Crew 6. Crew booking point(s) used for Ghugus coal links and the usual crew change point. 7. Frequency with which coal trains in this circuit are stabled for want of crew or because duty hours expire, and typical waiting time for a relief crew.

D. Brake Power Certificate / examination (Mechanical) 8. Nominated base examination depot for the closed-circuit rakes serving Ghugus. 9. Typical elapsed time for intensive examination of a BOXN rake and the examination hours observed at that depot.

E. Loading (WCL Wani Area) 10. Loading method at Ghugus Old Siding (pay-loader / CHP / silo), working hours, and average placement-to-release time per rake. 11. Average rakes loaded per day at Ghugus during the last 12 months, by destination if available.

F. Unloading (CSTPS) 12. Number of wagon tipplers normally in service and the average unloading time per rake. 13. Average rakes received per day by rail and average detention from arrival to release.

All data will be used only for this academic project, will be reported in aggregated form, and the completed report can be shared with your office if desired. We would also be glad to present our findings to your team.

We thank you for your time and support.

Yours faithfully,

(Team RakeFlow) Names, roll numbers, contact email Faculty supervisor: _____, Department of IEOR, IIT Bombay